

5 High-Ticket AI Business Models: 90-Day Plans

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At a glance

Right, Tyler, straight answer first: all five of these can land you a client paying £1,500 or more within 10 to 12 weeks, if you put in 3 to 4 hours a day. My top pick for you is number 1, because it sells to the exact same Leicester businesses you'll already be talking to for the review replies.

A quick word on "high ticket." Online, people throw around £10k deals like they're nothing. For your first one at 20 with no track record, a realistic high ticket deal is £1,500 to £3,000 up front, or £500 to £1,500 a month. That's a proper win, and the bigger numbers come once you've got a case study.

Model	Typical first deal	Time to first deal	How hard to learn	Startup cost (approx.)
1. Lead follow-up automation for trades	£1,500 setup + £300 to £500/month	6 to 10 weeks	Medium	£100/month
2. AI phone receptionist for clinics	£2,000 setup + £400/month	8 to 12 weeks	Medium to hard	£50 to £100/month
3. Websites + local SEO for big-ticket trades	£2,000 to £4,000 one-off + £150/month	6 to 10 weeks	Medium	£30/month
4. Paid ads lead generation	£1,000 to £1,500/month (client pays ad spend)	8 to 12 weeks	Hard	£100 to £200 to test
5. Short-form video for local businesses	£1,000 to £2,000/month	4 to 8 weeks	Easy to medium	£20/month + your phone

Tool prices are from memory and move about, so check them before you sign up for anything.

1. Lead follow-up automation for trades

Here's the problem you fix. A kitchen fitter in Oadby gets an enquiry on a Tuesday, he's on a job, he rings back Thursday, and the customer's already booked someone else. Or he sends a £12,000 quote and never chases it. You set up a system that texts every new enquiry back within a minute, books them in for a quote, and follows up on every quote automatically for two weeks. He wins jobs he was losing without lifting a finger.

Who pays: kitchen and bathroom fitters, builders doing extensions, roofers, solar and heat pump installers, driveway and landscaping firms. Anyone whose average job is £5,000 or more. One extra job a year pays your whole fee, and that's how you sell it.

What you charge: £1,500 to set it up, then £300 to £500 a month to run it, tweak it and report on it.

Your 12-week plan

1. Weeks 1 and 2: learn the tools. Sign up for a GoHighLevel free trial and do the Make.com Academy basics. Build one workflow: form filled in, instant text back, a calendar booking link, then three follow-up texts over a week.
2. Week 3: build a demo for a made-up company, "Leicester Kitchens Ltd." Record a 3-minute screen video of you filling in the form on your phone and getting the text back. This video is your whole pitch.
3. Week 4: make a list of 60 trades in Leicestershire with an average job over £5k. Checkatrade, Google Maps and local Facebook groups are full of them.
4. Weeks 5 to 8: outreach. Call them between 7 and 8am or 4 and 5pm. Your opener: "How many quotes did you send last month that just went quiet?" Then text the demo video. Aim for 15 calls a day.
5. Weeks 6 to 8: offer your first 1 or 2 a setup at cost (say £300) in return for a testimonial and permission to share their numbers.
6. Weeks 9 to 12: go back to everyone who was interested with real results from client one ("Dave won 2 extra jobs in his first month") and pitch the full £1,500.

Upside

It's monthly money, so it stacks. Ten clients at £400 is £4,000 a month. Trades talk to each other at the builders' merchant, so referrals come easy once one's happy. And it fits straight on top of the review replies business: same customers, one conversation.

Downside

There's a learning curve, and the first build takes you a week of head-scratching. Tradesmen are hard to get on the phone and sceptical of anyone selling "marketing." If your texts go out at the wrong time or say something daft, it's their name on it. UK rules (PECR) mean you can only text people who've actually enquired, never cold lists.

Where to learn

What	Where	Cost
Automations (the core skill)	Make Academy, academy.make.com	Free
All-in-one CRM, texts, booking	GoHighLevel help centre and their YouTube channel	Free, software about £75/month after trial
Writing follow-up texts that get replies	Use Claude or ChatGPT with the prompt: "Write a 4-message follow-up for a £10k kitchen quote, friendly, from the owner"	Free

Best thing to learn first: Make.com. Once you understand "when this happens, do that," every other tool makes sense.

2. AI phone receptionist for clinics

Ring any private dentist, physio or vet at 6pm or on a Saturday and you'll get a voicemail. Most people don't leave one. They just ring the next clinic. You set up an AI voice assistant that answers when the front desk can't, sounds like a real person, answers the common questions (prices, opening times, parking) and books the appointment or takes the details for a callback.

Who pays: private dental practices, physios, chiropractors, vets, private GP and skin clinics, hair transplant clinics. A new private patient is often worth £500 to £2,000, so catching three extra a month is a no-brainer for them.

What you charge: £1,500 to £2,500 setup, then £300 to £500 a month (the call minutes cost you roughly £0.10 to £0.20 each, so build that in).

Your 12-week plan

1. Weeks 1 to 3: learn one voice platform properly. Retell AI or Vapi are the main ones. Build an assistant for a pretend clinic, "Clarendon Park Physio," with its prices, hours and FAQs.
2. Week 4: ring it 50 times yourself. Try to break it. Ask weird questions, mumble, interrupt. Fix everything it gets wrong. A clunky demo kills the sale on the spot.
3. Week 5: list 50 private clinics in Leicestershire. Ring each one after 6pm and note who goes to voicemail. That's your hit list.
4. Weeks 6 to 9: email or visit the practice manager (not the dentist; the manager runs the phones). Your line: "I rang you at 6:15 on Tuesday and got voicemail. Want to hear what your patients could get instead?" Then give them your demo number to ring.
5. Weeks 8 to 10: first client at a discount for 60 days, in exchange for a testimonial and call stats.
6. Weeks 10 to 12: full price pitches using "it answered 41 calls in its first month, 12 of them booked."

Upside

The demo sells itself. When a practice manager rings your number and has a natural chat with an AI, the jaw drops. Very few people in Leicester are offering this yet, and it's monthly income that's hard to cancel once they rely on it.

Downside

It's the most technical of the five. Voice AI still has bad days (lag, mishearing names), and if it messes up a patient call, you'll hear about it. Healthcare means UK GDPR: callers have to be told they're talking to an assistant and that calls are recorded, and you need a simple data agreement with the clinic. Never let it give medical advice. Practice managers are cautious and slow to decide, so allow 3 to 4 weeks from first chat to signed.

Where to learn

What	Where	Cost
Building voice agents	Retell AI docs (docs.retellai.com) or Vapi docs (docs.vapi.ai), both have quick starts	Free to learn, pay per minute
Connecting to calendars	Make Academy (same as model 1)	Free

What	Where	Cost
UK data rules in plain English	ICO website, "guide for small businesses" section	Free

Best thing to learn first: prompt writing for voice. How the assistant talks matters more than any tech. Practise writing a script that sounds like a friendly Leicester receptionist, not a robot.

3. Websites plus local SEO for big-ticket trades

Forget £300 websites for the chippy. Everyone's doing those, and the money's rubbish. You build proper sites for businesses where one customer is worth thousands, and you set them up to show on Google when someone searches "loft conversion Leicester." You're selling phone calls, not a pretty page.

Who pays: loft conversion and extension builders, kitchen showrooms, solar installers, wedding venues, private clinics, solicitors and accountants in small firms. Look for any business with a site that looks like it was built in 2014 and doesn't work on a phone.

What you charge: £2,000 to £4,000 for the site, then £150 to £300 a month for hosting, updates and one local SEO page a month.

Your 12-week plan

1. Weeks 1 to 3: learn Framer or Webflow (both let AI do a lot of the layout now). Build 3 sample sites for made-up businesses: a builder, a clinic, a kitchen showroom. These are your portfolio.
2. Week 3: work through Google's free SEO Starter Guide. Learn the basics: page titles, a page for each service and each town they cover, Google Business Profile, reviews.
3. Week 4: find 50 targets. Google "extensions Leicester," "loft conversion Market Harborough" and so on, and open every site on your phone. Old, slow or broken ones go on the list.
4. Weeks 5 to 8: for your top 10, build a homepage mock-up of what their new site would look like (AI makes this an hour's work each). Email it over: "I redid your homepage to show you what it could look like. Fancy a chat?" Nothing beats someone seeing their own business looking smart.
5. Weeks 7 to 9: first client. Take 50% up front, 50% on launch. Always.
6. Weeks 10 to 12: use that site and a quote from the owner to pitch the next 20.

Upside

It's the easiest to understand. Everyone knows what a website is, so there's no explaining. The up-front money is big and arrives in one go. The monthly care plan builds steady income, and once you're in, they'll ask you for everything else (ads, automations, reviews).

Downside

The market's crowded and plenty of people undercut on price. Clients can drag their feet sending photos and text for weeks, so put deadlines in your agreement. SEO takes 3 to 6 months to show results, so you need to be honest about that up front or they'll get impatient. Scope creep is real: "can you just add a booking system?" needs a polite "yes, that's £400."

Where to learn

What	Where	Cost
Building sites	Webflow University or Framer Academy	Free, sites about £15 to £30/month each
SEO basics	Google Search Central SEO Starter Guide	Free
Local SEO and keywords	Ahrefs Academy free courses and their YouTube channel	Free

Best thing to learn first: local SEO, not design. Plenty of people can make a site look nice. Very few can make the phone ring, and that's what clients pay for.

4. Paid ads lead generation

You run Facebook, Instagram and Google ads for a local business and hand them a steady flow of people asking for quotes or booking consultations. AI writes your ad copy, makes variations of the images and helps you read the numbers. You're paid a monthly fee, and the client pays Meta or Google for the ads directly.

Who pays: home improvement firms (windows, doors, driveways, conservatories, solar), private dentists for implants and Invisalign, gyms and personal trainers, driving schools. Pick one niche and stick to it so you get good at it fast.

What you charge: £800 to £1,500 a month, plus they pay at least £500 to £1,000 a month in ad spend. Some people charge per lead (say £25 a lead) instead, which is easier to sell when you're new.

Your 12-week plan

1. Weeks 1 to 3: do Meta's free Blueprint courses on Ads Manager and Google's Skillshop on Search ads. Learn the basics: audiences, a lead form, what a good cost per lead looks like.
2. Weeks 3 to 5: spend £100 to £200 of your own money running real ads. Easiest test: run ads for a mate's business or a family member's for free, so you've got real numbers to show. Or run lead ads for your own review business and kill two birds with one stone.
3. Week 5: pick your niche and list 50 businesses in the East Midlands. Check the Meta Ad Library (free, anyone can search it) to see who's already running ads. Those are your best targets, because they already believe in ads and just need someone better.
4. Weeks 6 to 9: outreach. "I looked at your ads in the Ad Library. You've been running the same one since June. I'd test 5 new ones for you, free for the first two weeks, and you only pay the ad spend."
5. Weeks 8 to 10: land a first client on a 30-day trial.
6. Weeks 10 to 12: show them a report with cost per lead and booked jobs, switch them to paid, and use those numbers to pitch the next ones.

Upside

This is the most "scalable" of the five. The same skill works for a window company in Leicester or a dentist in Manchester, so you're not tied to walking distance. Good ad people are always in demand, and results are measurable, so a happy client stays for years.

Downside

You're judged on results you don't fully control. Bad week, bad offer, or the client never rings the leads back, and you get the blame. The learning curve is steep and costs real money while you learn. UK rules matter: you can't advertise Botox or any prescription medicine to the public at all, and health and finance ads have strict ASA rules, so steer clear of aesthetics as a beginner. Meta can also ban ad accounts with little warning.

Where to learn

What	Where	Cost
Facebook and Instagram ads	Meta Blueprint (free courses on Meta's site)	Free
Google ads	Google Skillshop	Free
Seeing competitors' ads	Meta Ad Library	Free

What	Where	Cost
UK advertising rules	ASA and CAP website, "advice online"	Free

Best thing to learn first: writing the offer, not working the dashboard. "Free driveway design visit this week only" beats "Quality driveways" every time, whatever your targeting.

5. Short-form video for local businesses

Every business owner knows they "should be on TikTok and Reels" and almost none of them do it. You turn up once a month, film for two hours, and turn it into 12 to 20 short videos with AI doing the heavy editing: auto captions, cutting out the umms, picking the best clips. Then you post them for them.

Who pays: estate agents, personal trainers and gyms, barbers and salons with a bit of money, restaurants on the Golden Mile, car dealers and detailers, tradesmen who do satisfying work (driveways, pressure washing, renovations). Before and after content does brilliantly.

What you charge: £800 to £2,000 a month depending on how many videos and whether you post and reply to comments too.

Your 12-week plan

1. Weeks 1 and 2: learn CapCut properly and try Opus Clip or Descript for cutting long footage into short clips. Study 50 local business videos that went well and note the hook in the first 2 seconds.
2. Weeks 2 to 4: make a portfolio for free. Offer 3 Leicester businesses (start with the ones from your review list) a free month of videos. Real local examples beat any course.
3. Week 4: start your own Instagram or TikTok showing the work, like "I made this barber on Narborough Road 10 videos in a day." Behind the scenes content gets you clients by itself.
4. Weeks 5 to 8: pitch with the portfolio. Walk-ins work best here. Show them the video you made for the shop down the road on your phone.
5. Weeks 6 to 9: convert the free clients who saw results into paid, and sign 1 or 2 new ones at full price.
6. Weeks 10 to 12: build a monthly routine (one filming day per client, editing batches) so you can handle 5 to 6 clients.

Upside

Fastest to get going, and you can start this week with just your phone. You're 20, which actually helps here: owners assume you know TikTok better than them, and they're right. The work is visible, so every video you post is an advert for you. It's also fun, which counts for a lot when you're grinding.

Downside

It's time-heavy. AI speeds up editing, but you still have to be there to film, and owners cancel or turn up camera-shy. Results (views) are unpredictable and don't always turn into customers, so some clients cancel after 3 months. It's harder to charge £2k a month than with the other models, because lots of students offer cheap editing. Your edge has to be strategy (hooks, ideas, what sells) not just editing.

Where to learn

What	Where	Cost
Editing	CapCut's built-in tutorials and YouTube	Free, Pro about £8/month
AI clipping and captions	Opus Clip or Descript free tiers	Free to start
What makes videos work	Save every local business video with big views and copy the structure, not the content	Free

Best thing to learn first: hooks. The first 2 seconds decide everything. Write 10 hook lines for every video before you film.

My pick for you, and what to learn first

If I were you, Tyler, I'd do this: run the review replies business for cash flow in weeks 1 to 4, and learn Make.com in the evenings. From week 5, start pitching model 1 (lead follow-up automation) to the trades and garages you're already talking to. You're already in the door. "I've sorted your reviews; want me to make sure you never lose another quote?" is a far easier sale than a cold call, and that's how a £129 client becomes a £2,000 one.

Why not the others first? Voice AI (model 2) is the natural next step after model 1, using the same skills, so save it for month 4. Websites (model 3) are a crowded market. Ads (model 4) cost you money to learn and you carry the blame for results. Video (model 5) is fun and fast but it's harder to get up to high ticket prices, and it eats your time.

What's best to learn, in this order:

1. Selling. Honestly, this is the big one. Every model above lives or dies on whether you can pick up the phone and have a normal chat with a business owner. Read "\$100M Offers" by Alex Hormozi (or listen to it on Audible), then practise your opener 20 times out loud.
2. Make.com automations (free, Make Academy). This one skill unlocks models 1 and 2 and makes you faster at everything else.
3. Writing good prompts. Every tool here, from voice agents to ad copy, runs on how well you can tell an AI what you want. Practise daily on real tasks.
4. Basic UK business admin. Register as a sole trader, write a one-page client agreement (scope, price, 50% up front, 30 days' notice to cancel), and keep receipts.

One warning, neighbour to neighbour: you'll see loads of people on YouTube and TikTok selling £2,000 "AI agency" courses with screenshots of £30k months. Don't buy them. Everything you need is in the free resources above, plus picking up the phone. Spend that money on a month of software and business cards instead.

Your next step this week: keep going with the review replies plan, and spend 30 minutes a night on Make Academy. By week 5 you'll be ready to pitch automation to people who already trust you.